

Murder suspects claim police beat them up

SELAYANG: They were brought to the Selayang magistrate's court yesterday to face a murder charge but they did not look a bit worried.

In the dock were K. Devakanan, 27, of Desa Jaya Kepong; Mathews Simon Anthony, 26, of Sungai Buloh; Sugumaran Letchumanan, 27, of Batu Caves and Prabakaran Sanathar Singh, 19, also of Batu Caves.

They were charged with murdering Mohd Hanapiah Ishak, 35, at Pencawang Maxis Kampung Desa Aman Puri, Batu 11, Sungai Buloh, Gombak, between Dec 31 last year at 11.30pm and 9.25pm the following day.

The accused were said to have used a stick, iron rod and stone. The four were charged under Section 302 of the Penal Code which carries the death sen-

tence, and was read together with Section 34 of the same code.

Rajpal Singh is representing Devakanan, a grocery store owner, and Mathews Simon, a van driver. Sugumaran, a grass-cutter, and Prabakaran, unemployed, were unrepresented.

Rajpal told the court that during remand, his clients said they were beaten up by police and had sustained bruises.

"I believe the rest (of the accused) were also beaten up, so I urge the court to allow them to make a police report," he said, as the four accused took off their shirts to show magistrate Nur Azhar Kassim their bruises.

Nur Azhar ordered the four to make a police report and to go for a medical examination.

The four also face another charge of attempted theft.



From left: Devakanan, Mathews, Sugumaran and Prabakaran at the court yesterday

Bail denied to mechanic on sodomy charge

KLANG: The Klang Sessions Court yesterday denied bail to a mechanic charged with sodomising and robbing a student at an oil palm plantation.

He is alleged to have committed the offences on a 17-year-old youth.

Defence counsel Shari'ah Abu who was representing the accused, T. Thirukumaran, 26, appealed to the court to allow him bail, saying the accused had a family to support.

DPP Salim Shuib objected to bail, saying that the offence was a very serious one.

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